Closing the Loop

Civic Skill: Voice & Participation | EYLF: EYLF Outcome 2 (Community) & Outcome 4 (Learning) | Duration: 20–30 minutes | Age: 4–6 years

LEARNING INTENTION

Children will revisit a previous consultation and see what happened as a result, learning that being listened to means something is actually done, or honestly explained.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can remember an idea I shared before.
- I can see or hear what happened with our ideas.
- I can say how it feels when grown-ups tell us what they did with our ideas.

MATERIALS

- Documentation from an earlier consultation in your room (e.g., the Idea Basket, a mural, or a past class decision)
- A simple 'What Happened Next' display board
- Drawing materials for children's feedback responses

ACTIVITY STEPS

1. REVISIT (5 min): Bring out documentation from an earlier session. Remind children what they shared and how.

2. REVEAL (7 min): Honestly explain what was done with the ideas — what was used, what wasn't, and why, in age-appropriate language. Avoid vague reassurance; be specific.

3. DISCUSSION (6 min): 'How does it feel to see what happened to your idea? Even the ideas we didn't use — were they still important?'

4. WHAT HAPPENED NEXT BOARD (7 min): Children add a drawing or short reflection showing how the outcome makes them feel.

5. CLOSING (2 min): Introduce the idea that grown-ups who ask children questions should always come back and tell them what happened.

EXTENSIONS	ASSESSMENT
• Make 'closing the loop' a standing ritual after every consultation activity in the room • Invite the person responsible for a decision (director, committee member) to personally explain an outcome to the children • Track over the term how many consultations were genuinely closed with feedback	• Note whether children can recall and connect their earlier contribution to the outcome • Observe emotional responses to feedback — including when an idea wasn't used • Learning story: document a child's reflection on having their idea acknowledged, used or not

EDUCATOR REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- How consistently do you currently close the loop with children after asking for their views?
- What structures could make 'closing the loop' automatic, rather than something that depends on remembering?
- How did children respond to hearing that an idea wasn't used? What does that tell you about how to frame this honestly?

EYLF LINKS

This lesson directly supports EYLF Outcome 2 (Community) & Outcome 4 (Learning). Educators should record observations using anecdotal notes, photographs, or learning stories focused on children's language, body responses, and social interactions during the session.